



./Award for excellence'- first of its kind in India was organised at the residence of Haryana Chief Minister

RECOGNISING Merit

All those days of burning the proverbial midnight oil were past and it was time to savour the success. No doubt the successful students were seen grinning from ear to ear as they recently assembled at the residence of Haryana Chief Minister Bhopinder Singh Hooda. It was time to honour them for their outstanding achievements in academics and competitive exams. And the fact that the state government was formally doing it for the first time made the occasion all the more memorable.

The Chief Minister conferred awards and cash prizes on 131 meritorious students of the state at the First Haryana Pratibha Samman Samaroh for excellence in education.

At the function which was largely attended, Hooda complimented the students, parents and teachers for bringing laurels to the state. He asked them to "have faith in them as great convictions led to great deeds". He hoped the other students would also take a leaf out of the book of these students and strive for excellence.

He underlined education as a prerequisite for all the development taking place worldwide. The countries that did not emphasise on education in this age of globalisation would be left behind, he said.



"Our aim is to excel in education and we shall not spare any effort in making every citizen attain excellent education. We are proud of our achievements in education sector"

—Mange Ram Gupta Education Minister Haryana

The Chief Minister said the government was making efforts to provide education to all children so that the state could be a leader in education

too. He said the government had decided to provide free books to the students of Classes IX to XII in government schools from the next year, which would benefit about four lakh students and cost the exchequer Rs 13 crore annually. Earlier, the facility was confined to the students till Class VIII.

The Chief Minister said that with the advancement in communication, the world had shrunk and one could know the happenings around the world in no time. He asked these students to become the brand ambassadors of the state and bring it laurels, no matter wherever they worked.

The Chief Minister said he felt honoured in giving awards to the outstanding students. He said though emphasis was being laid on the development of infrastructure to improve the quality of life, they were also not neglecting the health and education sectors for the bright future of the state.

He said efforts were being made to ensure that no child remained illiterate. Therefore, a Rs 500-crore incentive-based scheme has been introduced to encourage the poor students to receive education and check the drop-out rate. Under this scheme, scholarships were being provided to poor students, he added.

Hooda said a number of prominent institutes in the fields of technology, health, management and education were being set up. The Rajiv Gandhi Education City was fast coming up in Sonapat, where foreign universities